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The Chief Editors
Journal of Official Statistics

Dear Editors,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, “Anytime-valid monitoring of repeated survey estimates under questionnaire redesign: An application to the Business Trends and Outlook Survey”, for publication as a research article in the Journal of Official Statistics.

Statistical offices release short-period estimates from rolling surveys, and users read each release as it appears. Two problems follow that standard tools do not handle: error control under continuous inspection and optional stopping, and the discontinuities produced by questionnaire redesigns. The manuscript proposes a monitor for the curvature of a published series. Its null hypothesis is local linearity with unknown level and slope and a separate unknown level for each questionnaire regime, and a mixture e-process built on the residuals gives a closed-form test that is valid for all values of these nuisance parameters. The basic monitor fails when the published standard errors are too small, when a redesign effect is proportional, or when the regime date is off by a wave, and the manuscript gives versions that restore validity in each case, with a proof for the unknown-scale version and a simulation study of the cost in power and information; it also reports that dependent errors are not covered. An application to the 56 published waves of the U.S. Census Bureau’s Business Trends and Outlook Survey on business use of artificial intelligence reports the sensitivity of each declaration, shows that the first one rests on a single large drop, and compares the monitor with a state-space model that, with a random-walk level, finds no evidence of changing growth.

The paper suits the journal because it addresses a problem that statistical offices and users of their series face, the interpretation of frequent releases across redesigns, and its practical recommendation is simple: agencies should publish the regime label with each series. The manuscript is original, is not under consideration elsewhere, and has not been published. It has no footnotes or endnotes, is anonymized, and has a separate title page. The analysis data and code are provided so that every number can be reproduced. I have no conflicts of interest to declare and I have not suggested reviewers.

Yours sincerely,

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